

Shane Maris

Design Systems Leader | Design Operations Strategy

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Design systems and design ops leader with over a decade at Southwest Airlines, currently driving strategy for the airline's customer-facing commercial design system, spanning responsive web and native iOS and Android. Built and scaled a design system from the ground up, from the initial org-wide tool migration to a governance model that now reaches over 2,700 users, and turned that work into outcomes senior leadership could act on.

EXPERIENCE — SOUTHWEST AIRLINES, 2011 TO PRESENT

Digital Product Manager, Design Operations

DEC 2022 TO PRESENT

- Led Southwest's migration off Sketch and Abstract onto Figma as the single org-wide design tool, growing adoption from roughly 20 seats to 2,706 total today (320 of those paid/functional) across 55+ teams; led onboarding company-wide and have set up 20 workspaces for groups across the organization
- Established design systems governance and adoption standards spanning UX Design, Creative Design, Product, and front-end engineering pods, coordinating across departments in Digital Experience, Technology, and Marketing
- Prototyped an AI-powered design system tool in a weekend — a component health dashboard, real-time Q&A agent, and governance intake system — avoiding a planned \$150K/year vendor purchase (Knapsack); currently paused while foundational v1 work brings HDS to a state that's actually AI-ready, informing the roadmap toward v2
- Directly managed a contractor through a proof-of-concept that validated extending HDS to native iOS and Android — work that led to a long-term contractor relationship I continue to manage today, including skip-level visibility with leadership
- Industry recognition: invited by Figma to co-present on its "In The File" content series, covering Southwest's design system journey and real-world use of the Design Token Playbook, variables, and Dev Mode

Lead UX Designer

MAR 2022 TO DEC 2022

- Defined and documented Heart Design System vision, establishing the strategic foundation for enterprise-scale governance

Senior UX Designer

FEB 2019 TO MAR 2022

- Pioneered the internal business case for design systems adoption at Southwest, early thinking that directly led to Heart DS
- Co-founded and co-led the UX Community of Practice (with another UX Designer), establishing shared design standards across teams

UX Designer

APR 2014 TO FEB 2019

- A core team member on Vision, Southwest's multi-year overhaul of southwest.com, designing and launching core customer flows including Flight Status, Check-In, Cancel, Plan Trip, My Account, Rapid Rewards Shopping, and the original WiFi/IFE Portal, plus the EarlyBird Standalone flow, Business Select upgrades, and the Gift Card purchase experience

Web Designer

FEB 2012 TO APR 2014

- Transitioned from contractor to FTE; designed and built Southwest's first mobile-optimized sale landing page, driving a 200% increase in mobile shopping immediately post-launch

UX Designer (Contractor)

AUG 2011 TO FEB 2012

- Integrated AirTran's digital presence into the Southwest ecosystem following the airlines' merger

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

B.A. Interactive Media Design

Art Institute of Dallas, 2008 to 2011

NN/g Certificate in User Experience, with Specialty Recognition in UX Management

Nielsen Norman Group, 2022 to 2025

ICAgile Certified Professional, Agile Team Facilitation (ICP-ATF)

January 2022

EXPERTISE

Design Ops · Design Systems · Figma Enterprise Administration · Figma Governance · Cross-Functional Leadership · Design System Governance · Federated Contribution Models · AI Tooling Strategy · AI Adoption · UX Research & Strategy · Stakeholder Management · Executive Communication · Mentoring · Accessibility (WCAG) · Design Token Systems